

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 878

By Massey

A RESOLUTION to honor Diana Fisher, 2026 recipient of the John J. Duncan Sr. Award for Senior Advocacy.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should salute those citizens who, through their extraordinary efforts, have distinguished themselves as community leaders of whom we can all be proud; and

WHEREAS, one such individual is Diana Fisher, who was recently named the 2026 recipient of the John J. Duncan Sr. Award for Senior Advocacy; and

WHEREAS, the John J. Duncan Sr. Award for Senior Advocacy was created to honor those who steadfastly work to improve the lives of seniors in the Knoxville community, as the award's namesake did throughout his career; recipients are professionals and community members who have been nominated in recognition of their tireless efforts on behalf of seniors; and

WHEREAS, Ms. Fisher began her professional journey as an activities assistant in a nursing home, working directly with residents and discovering what would become her life's calling: caring for seniors with dignity, compassion, and excellence; and

WHEREAS, after earning a bachelor's degree in social work from East Tennessee State University, she served as a medical social worker, supporting patients and families through some of life's most challenging transitions and shaping a leadership philosophy grounded in the principle that operational excellence must always serve people first; and

WHEREAS, Diana Fisher steadily advanced through roles in admissions, regional marketing, and facility administration, successfully leading both seventy-nine-bed and 182-bed skilled nursing facilities; she built strong teams, strengthened census performance, and maintained regulatory integrity while balancing accountability with compassion; and

WHEREAS, today, as Senior Vice President of Strategy and Business Operations for Hillcrest Healthcare, Ms. Fisher leads system-wide growth initiatives, operational performance strategies, and program expansion across post-acute services; her leadership has strengthened financial stability, enhanced quality outcomes, and positioned her organization for long-term success; and

WHEREAS, Diana Fisher's influence extends beyond her organization, as she has served on the Statewide Coordinated Community Response Team as the Knoxville Regional Representative and currently serves on the Board of Directors for the Tennessee Center for Performance Excellence and on the Institutional Review Board for the University of Tennessee Medical Center, advancing quality, ethics, and accountability in health care statewide; and

WHEREAS, no stranger to accolades, she is the recipient of the Columbia/HCA Caregiving Award, a testament to her lifelong commitment to compassionate leadership; and

WHEREAS, in addition to her professional endeavors, Diana Fisher serves on the worship team at Piney Grove Baptist Church and is most proud of being a devoted wife to Dave and mother to Zack; and

WHEREAS, for more than four decades, Ms. Fisher has exemplified selfless leadership through her unwavering commitment to older adults and their families; her career is a powerful reminder that leadership is not defined by position but by service, integrity, and the lives one impacts along the way; and

WHEREAS, Diana Fisher is most worthy of our approbation on this special occasion; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor and congratulate Diana Fisher, 2026

recipient of the John J. Duncan Sr. Award for Senior Advocacy, extending our best wishes for her continued success.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.